Hustle Hive CIC – Staff Code of Conduct

Item	Detail
Organisation	Hustle Hive CIC, company no. 16691281
Policy lead	Gavin Copland, Director and Designated Safeguarding Lead
Version	1.0
Effective from	October 2026
Next review	September 2027, or sooner when *Keeping Children Safe in Education* changes

1. Purpose and scope

This code sets out the standards of behaviour we expect from everyone who works with Hustle Hive CIC, so that children, young people and adults are kept safe and staff are protected from situations that could be misunderstood. It applies to directors, employees, sessional and freelance staff, volunteers and students on placement, both during our activities and in their personal lives where their behaviour could affect their suitability to work with children.

Everyone must read this code during induction, sign the declaration at the end and follow it alongside our Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy and Part 1 of *Keeping Children Safe in Education*. The code cannot cover every situation. If you are unsure what to do, use your professional judgement, act in the best interests of the learner, and talk to the Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL).

2. Core principles

Everyone working with us will:

- put the safety and wellbeing of learners first;
- treat everyone with dignity and respect, and never discriminate;

- be a positive role model and act with honesty and integrity;
- keep clear professional boundaries with learners at all times;
- be open and transparent, so that nothing they do could reasonably be misinterpreted;
- report concerns promptly, including about colleagues and themselves; and
- uphold the reputation of Hustle Hive CIC, inside and outside work.

3. Relationships and boundaries with learners

Position of trust

Everyone working with our learners is in a position of trust. Staff must never develop a personal, romantic or sexual relationship with a learner, or behave in a way that could be seen as grooming, such as giving special attention, secrets, gifts or private contact. Any sexual activity with a learner under 18 by someone in a position of trust is a criminal offence, whatever the learner's apparent consent.

Contact and communication

- Only contact learners, and their parents or carers, through Hustle Hive CIC phones, email accounts or approved platforms, and only for work purposes.
- Never give learners your personal phone number, email, home address or social media details, and never ask for theirs.
- Never contact learners through personal social media or messaging apps, or accept or send friend or follow requests to or from current or recent learners.
- Keep all communication professional in tone and content. If a learner contacts you through a personal channel, do not reply; tell the DSL.

Social media and your online presence

Make your personal social media accounts private. Do not post anything about learners, families or confidential matters, or anything that could bring Hustle Hive CIC into disrepute or call into question your suitability to work with children.

Physical contact

Physical contact must only be appropriate to the situation, such as guiding a learner's hand on a tool, giving first aid or comforting a distressed young child briefly. Always think about the learner's age, needs and wishes, explain what you are doing and stop if they are uncomfortable. Physical intervention is only used in the exceptional circumstances set out in our Behaviour and Positive Conduct Policy, and must always be recorded.

One-to-one work

Work one-to-one in a visible place, such as a room with the door open or a vision panel, and make sure another adult knows where you are. Never be alone with a learner in a closed room, a private home or out of sight without agreement from a Director.

Transport

Only transport learners when agreed in advance, with written parental consent and in an insured, roadworthy vehicle. Where a single member of staff drives a learner alone, a Director must agree it beforehand, the learner sits in the back, and you tell a colleague when you set off and arrive. Never give a learner a lift on the spur of the moment.

Photographs and video

Only take images of learners on Hustle Hive CIC devices, for an agreed purpose and with consent. Never take, store or share images of learners on personal devices or accounts.

Gifts and favouritism

Do not give learners personal gifts, money or rewards outside our agreed reward systems, or show favouritism. You may accept small tokens of thanks, such as a card or chocolates. Tell a Director about any gift worth more than £20, or any repeated gifts.

Personal care

Where a learner needs help with intimate or personal care, staff only provide it as set out in the learner's healthcare plan, with consent, and in a way that protects the learner's dignity.

4. Professional conduct

Confidentiality and data

Keep information about learners, families and colleagues confidential, and only share it with people who need to know, in line with our Data Protection policy. Never discuss learners in public or online. Confidentiality never stops you passing on a safeguarding concern, and you must never promise a learner to keep a secret.

Dress and appearance

Dress in a way that is practical, safe for workshop activities and appropriate for working with young people. Follow the PPE requirements in our risk assessments, and tie back long hair and avoid loose clothing or jewellery when using equipment.

Alcohol, drugs and smoking

Never work under the influence of alcohol, illegal drugs or any substance that affects your judgement. Tell a Director if you are taking prescribed medicine that could affect your ability to work safely, especially when driving. Smoking and vaping are not allowed on our premises, on visits or in front of learners.

Equipment, IT and internet

Use Hustle Hive CIC equipment, accounts and Wi-Fi responsibly and mainly for work. Never use them to access, store or share inappropriate, offensive or illegal material. Keep passwords secure, lock devices when you leave them, and follow our Online Safety and Media Policy. Our devices are monitored.

Health and safety

Follow our Health & Safety Policy, risk assessments and safe operating procedures. Only use or supervise equipment you have been trained and signed off on. Report hazards, accidents and near misses straight away.

Honesty and conflicts of interest

Be honest in your records, timesheets, expenses and any information you give us or our partners. Tell a Director about any personal interest that could conflict with your work, such as a family relationship with a learner or a business connected to us.

Money and property

Handle any money for activities, sales or trips carefully: record it, get a receipt or second signature where possible and pay it in promptly. Never borrow money from, or lend money to, learners or families. Do not sell to or buy from learners or families privately.

Impartiality

Do not promote your own political, religious or personal views to learners. Where these topics come up in learning, present them in a balanced way.

Equality and respect

Treat everyone fairly and with respect, whatever their age, disability, race, religion or belief, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity or background. Challenge discriminatory language or behaviour when you see it.

5. Reporting concerns

Concerns about a learner

Report any concern about a learner's safety or welfare to the DSL straight away, following our Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy.

Concerns about another adult

If you are worried about the behaviour of anyone working with learners, report it, however minor it seems.

- **Allegations** that an adult may have harmed a child, or may pose a risk, go to the DSL. If the concern is about Gavin Copland or Kieron Davis, it goes to the other Director, who contacts the LADO within 24 hours. You can always contact the Darlington LADO directly on 01325 405319.
- **Low-level concerns** are behaviour that does not meet the threshold for an allegation but does not fit this code, such as being over-friendly or messaging a learner. Record them on our low-level concern form and pass them to the DSL, or to the other Director if the concern is about Gavin Copland or Kieron Davis.
- **Wider concerns** about wrongdoing or unsafe practice can be raised under our Whistleblowing Policy.

Reporting about yourself

Tell the DSL straight away if:

- you are arrested, charged, cautioned or convicted of any offence, or are under investigation;
- anything happens in your personal life, or to someone you live with, that could affect your suitability to work with children; or
- you find yourself in a situation with a learner that could be misinterpreted, such as a learner who seems to have developed a crush on you, or contact outside sessions.

Reporting your own behaviour early protects you and the learner.

6. Breaches of this code

Breaches will be looked into and may lead to further training, removal from working with learners, or action under our disciplinary procedures, including dismissal. Serious breaches may be referred to the LADO, the police, the DBS or, for qualified teachers, the Teaching Regulation Agency.

7. Review

This code is reviewed every year, and sooner when *Keeping Children Safe in Education* or other guidance changes.

Related policies

Read this code alongside our Safeguarding and Child Protection, Behaviour and Positive Conduct, Online Safety and Media, Whistleblowing, Safer Recruitment, Health & Safety, Medical Needs and Medicines, and Data Protection policies.

Approval and signatures

This code has been approved by the Board of Directors of Hustle Hive CIC.

Name	Position	Signature	Date
Gavin Copland	Director and DSL		
Kieron Davis	Director and deputy DSL		
Carey Viala	Director		
Sarah Smith	Director		

Appendix: Staff declaration

I confirm that I have read and understood the Hustle Hive CIC Staff Code of Conduct, the Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy and Part 1 of *Keeping Children Safe in Education*. I agree to follow them, and I understand that breaching this code may lead to disciplinary action and referral to outside agencies.

I confirm that I will tell the DSL straight away about anything that could affect my suitability to work with children.

Name	
Role	
Signature	
Date	
Received by (Director)	